

Moonsea Rising - 20231105

A Fungus Among Us

Beitris summons her spiritual weapons to attack the giant fungus. Lennox rushes forward, wielding his axe, and striking the nearest one twice. Taevyn flips behind it, slashing it with his rapier. Two of the smaller mushrooms move up, flailing ineffectually at Lennox. Lirael recognizes the large ones as fungal assassin vines -- very dangerous if they succeed at ambushing people. She calls out, "use your torches, and don't let them grab you!" Lashing out with tanglefoot, she wraps the nearest assassin vine in sticky sap. The other one lashes out at Taevyn, striking him with a tentacle. The tangled one wraps Lennox in a constricting grasp.

Harken throws his oil flask between the two assassin vines, followed closely by his lit torch. As the oil catches, another assassin vine flows up out of the nearest bush, missing him. Beitris lashes out at the most injured vine with divine lance, burning it badly. Lennox swings at it, hacking the body of the thing to pieces, freeing himself from its grasp. Swinging wildly, he turns towards the smaller mushroom, smashing it twice.

Taevyn moves back towards the entry way, engaging the vine by Harken. Lennox continues to fight off the mushroom in front of him, as it's joined by its companion. Lirael sends a searing bolt of light into the nearest one, splashing it with magical fire, and then shields herself. Harken slashes out with his weapons poking small holes in it with his rapier, but not doing much damage. The vine lashes out at Taevyn, but he dances aside, crashing his rapier down into it, knocking it askew, and parrying its follow up attack.

Beitris directs the spiritual weapon to smash the nearest vine, then showers Lennox with a healing burst of light, closing his wounds. With a roar, the giant man lashes out with the axe three times, nearly disassembling the smaller mushroom. Taevyn dances past the giant vine, lashing out with his rapier and leaving shreds of fungus mouldering on the ground behind him. The fungi around Lennox reach out for him, but only one connects a little. Lirael lashes out with a ray of frost, dispatching the damaged mushrooms, and maintaining her shield.

Harken grabs his torch off the floor and tries to fling it at the fungi ineffectively hassling Lennox, but he short-arms it, and it falls uselessly in the middle ground. The nearest mushroom turns on him, and rushes forward, spraying a facefull of spores at him, nauseating him. Beitris blasts him with healing light, and pushes at the remaining vine with her spiritual weapon. Lennox lashes out at the vine mass, tripping it somehow, then swinging his axe in an arc at it, smashing it into the floor. Taevyn flies over it in a cartwheel, dragging his rapier through it and reduces it to shreds on the floor again. Lirael sends the ray of frost at the mushroom at Lennox hitting it.

Harken continues to try and fight off the mushroom attacking him, as Beitris sends the spiritual weapon to help him. Lennox continues to hack at the mushroom still standing in front of him. Taevyn flies forward, kicking off the mushroom and coming down on it with his rapier, notching another kill. Whirling on the remaining mushroom, with a cool looking but difficult to describe maneuver, carving a giant chunk out of it. Lirael fires another ray of frost, as Harken pokes at it with his rapier, trying to end the torment. It lashes out at him further, and his sickness worsens, as chills

and shakes wrack his body. Beitris' spiritual weapons come down, finally killing the last of the mushrooms.

Harken drops to his knees, vomiting, as his skin takes on a purplish cast. Beitris rushes over praying under her breath. A lambent glow washes over Harken, and his skin returns his normal color.

Beyond the Violets

Moving the sign down the hall, they read it as part of the map. "Level B3", with arrows for "torture" and "clerical". Taevyn and Lennox are both excited to go through the northern passage towards "torture." There are skeletons in moldy armor, with arrows around as though they had been shot. The rot suggests they've been here possibly hundreds of years. Harken approaches cautiously, looking for traps. While he doesn't find any, he does find an arrow slit in the wall.

Taevyn and Lennox follow him, and hear screaming coming from behind the second door. It sounds like a woman screaming, "stop, please stop!" Taevyn opens the door, revealing a young woman being accosted by a man with a hot poker. Lirael and Taevyn both move to assist, but Beitris beats them both to it, sending a divine lance into the back of the torturer. Taevyn leaps forward, attempting and failing to spin the assailant away from his target. He swings at the poker, attempting to disarm the man. He calls out, "there's another one!"

The two men are wearing what looks clearly like ceremonial robes. The second man points a ring bearing a skull over a black sunburst on it, and a wall of force slams into Taevyn. He drops his shoulder, skidding sideways across the room. He comes to rest over a rune on the floor, from which tendrils of necrotic energy flare out, gripping him and sapping his strength. Harken fires his bow, missing, and shouts at the visible cultist, attempting to intimidate him. Lennox races up, sweeping a kick at the torturer's feet, and missing his follow-up stroke with his axe.

Lirael strides into the room. For a moment, she's confused, as their garb looks like ancient Zhen-tish priests of Cyric. Clearly, that's madness, as the Zhents were broken over 200 years ago. She yells to the torturer that he ought to fight someone who can defend themselves. He laughs, and plunges the poker into the woman's throat. "We'll get to you soon enough, sweet tits." He lashes out at Lennox and misses. From behind the arrow slot, a third man fires a crossbow at Lirael, striking her twice after quickly reloading.

Beitris casts a field of bane at the torturer, and he resists its effects for now. Taevyn tumbles back into the room, both hands braced on the rapier. Running the torturer through, he stands over the man's fresh corpse. Harken moves forward, menacing the other cultist with his bow, before loosing an arrow into him. Lennox sweeps the man's legs from under him, slamming his prone body with the axe. Lirael moves into the room, yelling that there's someone behind the arrow slit. She whips sappy vines at the other cultist, tangling his prone form. Behind her, a spear slashes out from the arrow slit, catching Beitris twice. She moves up, increasing the area of the bane, and shields herself.

Taevyn tumbles forward, awkwardly and unnecessarily, slashing at the cultist. He raises his ring and sends another wall force slamming into Taevyn, Lennox, and Lirael. They're all slammed back, and Lirael and Taevyn end up on the rune again. Harken telekinetically flings everything in the

room at the remaining cultist in the room, smashing him with the torture implements in the room, and striking him down.

Lennox rushes up to Lirael and pulls her out of the runic circle. She immediately shields herself, gasping that there's still someone behind the arrow slit firing on them. Beitris grabs Taevyn, pulling him out, and touches Lirael, healing her a little.

On the other side of the room, they hear someone shout "now!" The door flies open and arrows fly into the room. One strikes Taevyn, who immediately drops. The door immediately shuts and clicks as though it were locking. Harken draws his bow, aiming at the door. Lirael straightens whispers some arcane words, and shifts into a massive beetle. She turns towards the door, ready to rush it. Beitris casts a massive heal, catching everyone in the room.

Someone yells, "now!" and the door opens. Lennox immediately steps through, attacking the man behind the door. He swipes at Lennox, then whistles as a creature that looks like a zombified baboon bounds forward towards Lennox. Harken looses an arrow, hitting the cultist by the door. The baboon scratches Lennox and tries to grapple. Lirael skitters forward, slamming into the cultist by the doorway and pushing him back.

The bowman fires on Lennox, but misses him. The cultist at the door steadies himself, and pulls a vial of liquid from his pocket and prepares to lob it. Back in the prior room, Taevyn climbs to his feet. He attempts to distract the cultist, and moves into cover. Harken fires two arrows wildly, and shouts, "Cyril commands you to avert your eyes!" The one by the door inadvertantly looks down before catching himself.

Lirael snaps her mandibles on the door cultist twice, and he screams in pain as they clamp painfully on him. Beitris heals Taevyn, who seems much less close to death. She extends the bane. The archer fires on Lennox, and hurls the potion he was holding. The other cultist strikes at Lennox, but misses him. Lennox slashes at him with the axe, hitting him three times in rapid succession. The monkey swipes at him, missing him as well.

Taevyn leaps into the room, rolling past the baboon and lashing out with his rapier. Missing, he whirls on the cultist, but the man dodges his strike. Harken focuses on the cultist and slams him with the rubble in the room, dropping him instantly. Lirael snaps at the baboon, but misses him. Beitris steps into the center of the room and attempts to disrupt the undead baboon. Holy light surrounds him, burning him badly.

The remaining cultist fires on Lennox, attempting to kill the big man, but in the melee, all three go wide. Lennox attacks the baboon, hitting it once with his axe, and it returns the favor, though it misses each time. Taevyn inexplicably backflips before running through the baboon. He dances and tumbles around the archer, teeing him up for his killing blow. Harken uses his telekinesis again, but the cultist dodges the detritis. Lirael follows Taevyn, chomping on the cultist.

Beitris continues to extend the bane ring, and casts a divine lance at the cultist, but misses. The archer, committed to taking someone with him, fires on Lennox hitting the giant again, but failing to kill him. Lennox shares this commitment with him, at least. He advances, swinging his axe, and catching him a solid blow. Harken rains them with trash and effluvia but doesn't damage the cultist.

As Beitris heals Lennox, the party cuts down the final cultist. Dropping back into her elven form, Lirael slumps against the wall, breathing heavily.